

Tool

Assessing Customer Relationships

Businesses spend 80% of their marketing budget looking for new customers and clients instead of nurturing, retaining, and maintaining the customer relationships they have. This tool will help you assess the status of your relationship with your customers.

Review the questions in this tool and note down any ideas you have on how to implement the missing solutions or fix the way you are currently managing customer relationships. This will help you understand the state of your customer care strategies and help with ideas of areas you may be able to improve. The tool will also help you develop a plan for the areas of weakness you can improve to see better customer relationships

Guiding Questions	Your Notes
Do you have a customer database where you can access contact information, demographics, and purchase history so that you can follow-up with structured communication and surveys? ☐ Yes ☐ No <i>If yes, has your staff been trained? Do you follow up to ensure it is being correctly updated? Is it working?</i>	
Do you have a clear plan on how to communicate with your existing customers? Is your customer communication: ☐ Random and unstructured (When I think of it / if there's an issue) ☐ Very well structured (I have a schedule / plan) <i>If yes, has your staff been trained? Do you follow up to ensure it is being correctly implemented? Is it working?</i>	
How often do you follow up with your customers after they purchase your products? ☐ I rarely follow up with my customers ☐ I sometimes follow with my customers ☐ I always follow with customers What do you ask them?	
How do you collect feedback from your customers after purchase of product/service? <i>E.g. surveys, phone calls, email, etc. Please note down what tools you use and how frequently. Are they working?</i>	
Do you get customer input on what products/services they want you to offer? ☐ Yes ☐ No <i>If yes, how do you do it?</i>	
Which of the following question types do you use to assess the needs of your customers? •Do our products/services meet your needs? •Are there areas we can improve / services you need that we are not offering? •How can we improve our service? <i>It's a good idea to re-word these and write down which questions you will ask to make sure you're getting valuable customer</i>	

Do you communicate with your past customers to figure out why they left? ☐ Yes ☐ No If yes, how do you do it? Remember, common reasons for non-repeat of purchases include: •Being unhappy with pricing •Having an unresolved complaint •Feeling that you didn't care •Having a better offer from competitors Unless you resolve these issues, you will continue to lose customers.	
Do you track customer referrals? ☐ Yes ☐ No	
Do you know your Net Promoter Score (NPS)? ☐ Yes ☐ No If yes, what is it? <i>Your Net Promoter Score indicates how likely your customers are to recommend you to others. It's an important indicator of how you're doing.</i>	
Do you have a reward system for loyalty and referrals? ☐ Yes ☐ No If yes, how does it work?	

Action points

Pick 3-5 strategies from the ones above that you need to work on and define how you will implement them in your business. Be specific about the types of activities you will undertake and take the time to think through the detail of what you will do.

Strategy to work on	How you will implement it	Timelines